Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Adrian is quitting his bank job to become a chef. His old friend Abigail has just heard the news.

Abigail: So it's true? You're leaving the bank to train as a chef?

Adrian: Yep. **If I'd gone** to culinary school after high school, **I'd be running** my own place by now.

Abigail: Then again, **if you hadn't done** economics, **we wouldn't be** friends.

Adrian: True. But **if I weren't** so cautious, **I'd have quit** years ago.

Abigail: I'm a bit jealous, actually. I've always fancied being a vet.

Adrian: Seriously? It's not too late to retrain, you know.

Abigail: **If it weren't for** my mortgage, **I'd have done** it ages ago.

Adrian: Hey, I have one too. Just promise me you'll think about it.

Study Notes

I've always fancied being a vet.
Mình vẫn luôn mơ được làm bác sĩ thú y.
"fancy + V-ing" là cách nói của người Anh: thích, muốn làm gì. "vet" là cách gọi ngắn của "veterinarian".
Cách nói tương đương: I've always wanted to be a vet.

It's not too late to retrain, you know.
Học lại để chuyển nghề vẫn chưa muộn đâu.
"retrain" là học, đào tạo lại cho một nghề mới. "you know" ở cuối câu làm lời khuyên nghe thân mật, nhẹ nhàng hơn.
Cách nói tương đương: You can still change careers.

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. If I'd gone to culinary school after high school, I'd be running my own place by now.
linking: "If_I'd", "my‿own"
weak: "to"
strong: "culinary school", "own place", "now"
Chia hai cụm ở dấu phẩy: lên giọng nhẹ ở "high school", ngừng ngắn, rồi xuống giọng ở "now". "If I'd" nối thành "i-phaiđ"; "my own" thành "mai-yôn".

2. But if I weren't so cautious, I'd have quit years ago.
weak: "I'd have"
linking: "years‿ago"
strong: "cautious", "quit"
"I'd have" đọc lướt thành "ai-đơv", nói nhanh chỉ còn "ai-đơ". "cautious" đọc /ˈkɑːʃəs/ "ca-shợs" (giọng Anh: "co-shợs"). "years ago" nối thành "yiar-zơ-gô".

3. If it weren't for my mortgage, I'd have done it ages ago.
linking: "If_it", "ages‿ago"
weak: "for"
strong: "mortgage", "ages"
Chữ "t" trong "mortgage" câm: /ˈmɔːgɪdʒ/ "mo-gịch" (giọng Anh không đọc /r/). "If it" nối thành "i-phít"; "ages ago" thành "ây-ji-zơ-gâu".

• Câu điều kiện dài: ngắt hơi sau vế "if", lên giọng nhẹ ở chỗ ngắt, xuống giọng ở cuối câu.
• "I'd have" (would have) nói nhanh thành "ai-đơv" hoặc "ai-đơ": I'd have quit → "ai-đơ quít".
• Giọng Anh (Abigail) không đọc /r/ cuối âm tiết: weren't → "wơnt", mortgage → "mo-gịch".
• Giọng Mỹ (Adrian) đọc rõ /r/: weren't → "wơrnt", years → "yiarz".

Grammar Focus

Câu điều kiện hỗn hợp: quá khứ → hiện tại

Giả định quá khứ khác đi thì bây giờ đã khác: If + quá khứ hoàn thành, would + động từ nguyên mẫu. Hay đi với now, by now, still.

If I'd taken that job, **I'd be living** in Tokyo now.
If she hadn't missed the bus, **she'd be** here by now.
If I hadn't learned English, **I wouldn't have** this job.

Câu điều kiện hỗn hợp: hiện tại → quá khứ

Giả định một đặc điểm hiện tại khác đi thì việc trong quá khứ đã khác: If + quá khứ đơn, would have + V3. Hay dùng khi nói về tính cách.

If I were braver, **I'd have asked** her out.
If he didn't speak French, **he wouldn't have landed** the job.
If it weren't for you, **I'd have given up**.

Role Play track 6

A: So it's true? You're leaving the bank to train as a chef?

B: Yep. If I'd gone to culinary school after high school, I'd be running _____ by now.

A: Then again, if you hadn't done economics, we wouldn't be friends.

B: True. But if I weren't so _____, I'd have quit years ago.

A: I'm a bit jealous, actually. I've always fancied being a vet.

B: Seriously? It's not too late to retrain, you know.

A: If it weren't for my mortgage, I'd have done it ages ago.

B: Hey, I have one too. Just promise me you'll _____.

Substitution Drill track 7

1. I'd be running my own place by now.
   a. a food truck
   b. my own bakery
   c. a cooking school

2. But if I weren't so cautious, I'd have quit years ago.
   a. scared of change
   b. worried about money
   c. attached to my salary

3. Just promise me you'll think about it.
   a. sleep on it
   b. look into it
   c. at least try